

Spanish

(AQA, A Level)

"It is arrogant to assume that we can get by in English or that everyone else will speak our language. Learning a foreign language is polite, demonstrates commitment – and in today's world is absolutely necessary."

Sir Trevor MacDonald, Chair, Nuffield Language Inquiry

The A Level Spanish course builds on the knowledge, understanding and skills gained at GCSE. You will gain a range of transferable skills including communication, critical thinking, research skills and creativity. As well as developing your language skills, you will widen your knowledge and understanding of themes relating to the culture and societies where Spanish is spoken. Examples include technological and social changes, highlights of Spanish-speaking artistic culture, including Hispanic music and cinema as well as current issues affecting the Spanish-speaking world. The most successful A level linguists have always shown a commitment to and an enjoyment of the subject which extends way beyond the classroom. We encourage you to read foreign language magazines, news articles and books, participate in theatre and cinema visits, and attend lectures out of school. You will also be eligible to participate in our Exchange visit to Salamanca or organise your own study trip or work experience in a Spanish-speaking country.

Entry Requirements:

Grade 6 in GCSE Spanish.

Course Content

A level	%	When?	Content
Paper 1: Listening, Reading and Writing 2 hours 30 minutes	40%	June 2027	Listening and responding to spoken passages from a range of contexts and sources. Reading and responding to a variety of texts written for different purposes, drawn from authentic resources. Translation from Spanish into English. Translation from English into Spanish.
Paper 2: Writing 2 hours	30%	June 2027	Either one question in Spanish on a set text, or one question on a set film, or two questions on set texts. Questions will require a critical and analytical response to the work studied.
Paper 3: Speaking 21-23 mins	30%	May 2027	Discussion of a sub-theme based on a stimulus card (5 - 6 minutes) Presentation (2 minutes) and discussion (9 - 10 minutes) of individual research project

A one year AS qualification in Spanish is also available and will be examined in May/June 2026.

Costs associated with this course

Textbook: AQA Spanish A level and Year 1 (ISBN: 978-0-19-836690-4) Paperback 26/05/2016. Cost approximately £25, second-hand books often available.

Career Links

You could study Spanish at degree level either alone or as part of a combined degree, and you will have developed the skills to learn new languages. A variety of career options are open to students of Spanish, whether you choose to work at home or abroad, for example in business, engineering, scientific research, technology, journalism, international aid, media, entertainment, the leisure industry or teaching.

For more information please contact Miss Maguire